

Kodi: Your Open Source Playback Companion

Open source media players are a blessing for users looking for smooth entertainment solutions. Kodi is a comprehensive open source media playback software that can run on a plethora of platforms including Windows, iOS, Linux, Raspberry Pi and Android. It is commonly used to stream and play media files online or locally on computers or handsets. Here we explore more about Kodi.

What Kodi does

Multiplatform home theatre application is widely adopted due to its high customisability. The Kodi media centre is a fun tool to browse through audios and videos available in the system. Additionally, third-party application plug-ins can expand the usability of Kodi up to the Internet. For example, applications like Netflix and Pandora enable users to access streaming media online. Kodi runs in a full-size user interface (UI) by default. The home screen and UI might appear slightly crowded due to the huge range of options available in the software.

Media streaming. The Kodi toolbar packs a bunch of options including Movies, TV Shows, Music Videos, TV, Radio, Pictures, Videos, Add-ons, Favourites and Weather. In media-streaming options like movies, videos and music, users get to browse through the different storage options or direct to the online network from where the media file needs to be streamed. Different browsing options include Internal Storage, External Storage, Network File System, Root File System, Universal Plug and Play (UPnP) device, Windows SMB network or playlists.

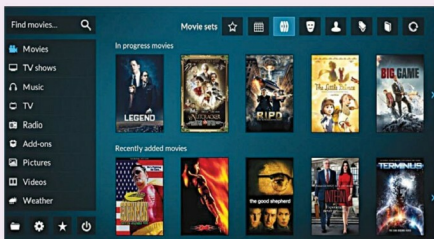


Fig. 1: The Kodi user interface

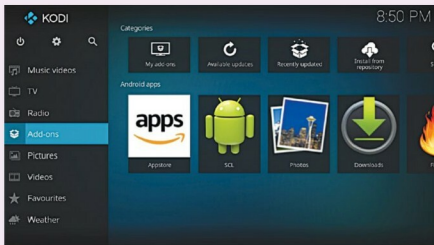


Fig. 2: Accessing add-ons on Android

Endless add-ons. Add-on options make Kodi highly scalable. The mega list of add-on browsers suggested by default is filled with variety. For instance, Kodi gives users the option to add media channels as diverse as 9GAG.TV, ABC Family, Apple iTunes Podcasts, Comic Vine, CNET Podcast, ESPN, IGN.com, Netflix and MTV, and access them from a single platform. Users can configure the plugins with their

preferable settings during playback.

The add-ons do not end at audio and video media—you can sync applications as well. For instance, if you are running Kodi on an Android platform, you can find all the applications installed on your system available and accessible from Kodi. You can download more applications as well. Under the 'Add-ons' tab, Kodi has a separate option called 'Download.' It has all